



Vimeo Record

The professional video platform has launched a new video messaging application. <http://dgit.in/nov20-83>



GGWP, Google Play Music

Google has started shutting down Google Play Music, pushes users to YouTube Music. <http://dgit.in/nov20-84>

The mystery of the missing packets

Agent001 starts troubleshooting a weird phenomenon with his network infrastructure

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y network setup isn't much to boast about. I've had a 1 Gbps internet connection for the past couple of

years which is channelled via a decent AC1900 Wi-Fi router in one corner of my home. I've got a hardline laid from the other end of my home to the main router. This is usually plugged into another router which I sometimes keep switching out for a couple of mesh nodes whenever I'm experi-

there are plenty of smartphones and a few smart devices. Over the years, I've been cutting the cord wherever possible to reduce the cabling mess so the laptops no longer get hard lines. All I'm left with is my PC and another machine which I treat as a NAS.

The Wi-Fi 6 router replaced my second router since I had no intention of messing around with the main router that blesses my home with the holy internet. Any and all experimentation can be done on any

The first few days were relatively unremarkable but a week down the line I noticed the router dropping clients willy-nilly. You could be watching a YouTube video or scrolling through Instagram Reels and the laptop or smartphone would lose network connection. On the phone, it was difficult to notice this since it would switch to LTE immediately and you'd only notice a momentary halt but the laptops would just stop in their tracks. Usually, clients get dropped quite often but the client will try to seek out the server and re-attempt to gain access. I'm assuming my laptops did try reconnecting but the router was a bit stand-offish and wouldn't let the device connect. Everything went back to normal within a minute or so but then the problem would resurface occasionally. Over the last couple of weeks, that problem started occurring at shorter intervals. I started facing the drops multiple times each day but my hardline devices weren't facing any issue.

I wrote to the device manufacturer and they sent a new firmware. Flashing that fixed the disconnection issue but after a few days I started experiencing interruptions all over again. This time around, the clients weren't getting dropped, instead, packets were mysteriously disappearing. Running the ping command for a prolonged period on my devices would show the hardline devices facing no interruption while



menting. Recently, I got my hands on a Wi-Fi 6 router courtesy of a new manufacturer. A lot has been written about Wi-Fi 6 and Wi-Fi 6E making them sound like the best damn thing since sliced bread so I was naturally curious to see how they'd affect my usage scenario.

There are quite a lot of networked devices at my place. There's my desktop PC a.k.a. my first love which always gets a hardline (get your mind out of the gutter!) and a couple of laptops used by my folks. Then

device other than my main router. After installing the Wi-Fi 6 router and replugging my hardlines, all my devices were handling the new router quite well. As expected no additional configuration was required. Not that I could configure stuff anyway since the new Wi-Fi 6 router features a very beginner-friendly and dumbed down UI with barely any granular configuration options to tweak. You could say, my beloved devices and I were at the mercy of this new network contraption.